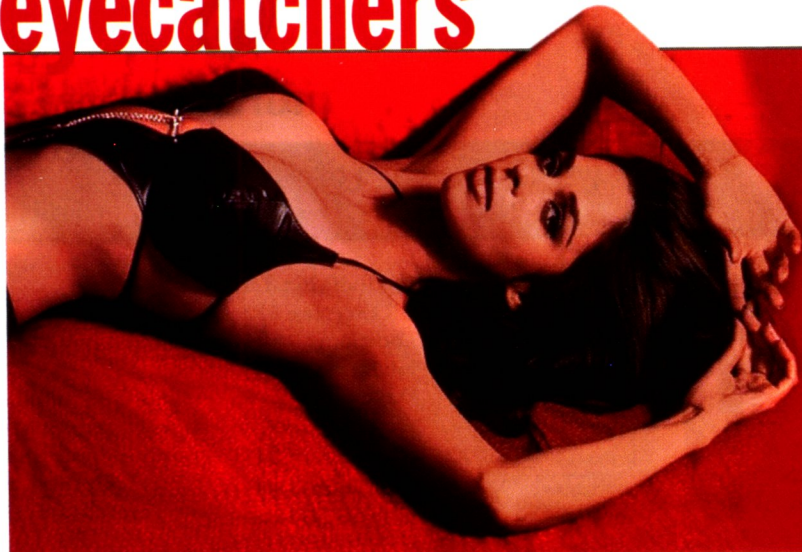




POLE CALL

What's better than just a pole dance? **Mallika Sherawat** doing it, of course. Kamal Hassan's *Dasavatham* may have the actor in ten roles, but with one lustful move around the pole wrapped in feather boa, Madam M is making the audience dizzy. "She's a dancer in a pub so we included a pole dancing montage to suit the role," says choreographer G. Brinda, who shot the song in two days and had worked with Sherawat on *Maiyya Maiyya*. First a belly jig, now a pole dance. What next?

In Transition

Models are a persistent lot. Though most ramp-to-screen moves have been no-shows, they just don't stop trying. The latest catwalker to be lured by camera and action is Miss India World 2006 Natasha Suri who has signed a three-film deal with Suniel Shetty's production house. "He had seen my pictures in some newspaper. I received a message from him and things fell into place. He's given me the freedom to choose my script," says Suri. Ah, happy hunting.



Item Magic

It's hard for actors to say no to a Yashraj Film—even if it's a cameo. Ameesha Patel who's been missing in action for some time has shot for a special song in Kunal Kohli's *Thoda Pyar Thoda Magic* that stars Saif Ali Khan and Rani Mukerji. But Kohli isn't happy with the 'item' number tag. "Yes it's a sensuous song but she also has an interesting guest appearance," he says. Will Kohli's wand revive Patel's lacklustre career?

ZEROING IN

We can't decide whether it's sexy or scary. After Kareena Kapoor whittled down for *Tashan*, best friend Amrita Arora is getting into her skinny jeans. The actress has shed whatever was left and looks like a skeletal version of her former self. "I've always been 49 kg but had gained weight a while ago," says Arora, who's taken the yoga route a la Bebo and is now down to 48 kg. "I am no where close to being anorexic. I eat seven meals a day as per my dietician." Why then do her recent pictures beg to differ? Bony is not so bodacious.



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